

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

B E S T

Start here

1

You wear it around your waist

2

It rings: ding-dong!

3

You kick or throw it in a game

4

One side of a room

W A L K

Finish here

Ladder 2

C O D E

Start here

1

Ice cream goes on top of it

2

A stick that helps someone walk

3

A sweet treat with candles on your birthday

4

Lots of fresh water with land all around

L I K E

Finish here

Ladder 3

H E L D

Start here

1

A big group of cows

2

The opposite of soft

3

It has four fingers and a thumb

4

Tiny grains you find on a beach

S E N D

Finish here

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

	B	E	S	T	Start here
1	B	E	L	T	You wear it around your waist
2	B	E	L	L	It rings: ding-dong!
3	B	A	L	L	You kick or throw it in a game
4	W	A	L	L	One side of a room
	W	A	L	K	Finish here

Ladder 2

	C	O	D	E	Start here
1	C	O	N	E	Ice cream goes on top of it
2	C	A	N	E	A stick that helps someone walk
3	C	A	K	E	A sweet treat with candles on your birthday
4	L	A	K	E	Lots of fresh water with land all around
	L	I	K	E	Finish here

Ladder 3

	H	E	L	D	Start here
1	H	E	R	D	A big group of cows
2	H	A	R	D	The opposite of soft
3	H	A	N	D	It has four fingers and a thumb
4	S	A	N	D	Tiny grains you find on a beach
	S	E	N	D	Finish here